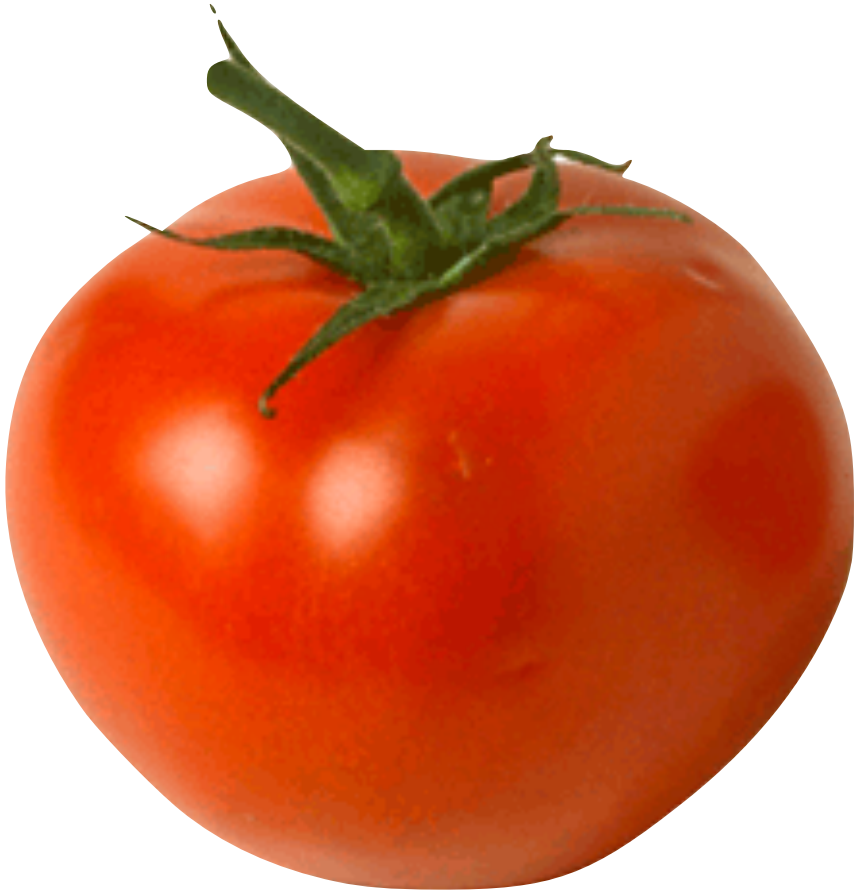




But this seems to show that conscious experience
is not a wholly physical process.

1. It is conceivable that two beings be physically the same but differ with respect to their phenomenal properties.
2. If a situation is conceivable, it is possible.
3. It is possible that two beings be physically the same but differ with respect to their phenomenal properties. (1,2)
4. Phenomenal properties are not physical properties. (3, definition of 'physical property')
5. If we are wholly physical things, then phenomenal properties are physical properties.
6. We are not wholly physical things. (4,5)
7. If we are not wholly physical things then immaterial souls exist.

C. Immaterial souls exist. (6,7)

Here is one way in which the argument, which is sometimes called the **knowledge argument**, can be laid out.

Suppose that you don't believe in immaterial souls. How should you respond?

THE CONCEIVABILITY ARGUMENT

One option is to deny premise (2), and say that sometimes situations can be conceivable, but not genuinely possible.

Here is a possible counterexample to this premise:

The barber

Deep in the Indiana countryside, there's a small town; and in this town there's a barber. Some of the men in this small town - the industrious ones - shave themselves every morning. But others (the lazy ones) don't; and the barber shaves all of them. (There's no one else around who will do it.) Moreover, he (the barber's a man) never shaves any of the industrious ones - he never shaves any of the men that shave themselves.

But this seems to show that conscious experience

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7 If we are not wholly physical things then material souls

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Suppose that you don't believe in immaterial souls. How should you

respond?



One option is to deny premise (2), and say that some situations

can be conceivable, but not genuinely possible.

Let's consider an objection to the second premise of Descartes' argument:



it is possible for it to be the case.

2. If I can clearly imagine something being the case, then

Here is a possible counterexample to this premise:

The barber

Deep in the Indiana countryside, there's a small town; and in this town there's a barber. Some of the men in this small town - the industrious ones - shave themselves every morning. But others (the lazy ones) don't; and the barber shaves all of them. (There's no one else around who will do it.) Moreover, he (the barber's a man) never shaves any of the industrious ones - he never shaves any of the men that shave themselves.